Little Fox Readers

Level 5

Journey to the West 20
The Black Bear Spirit



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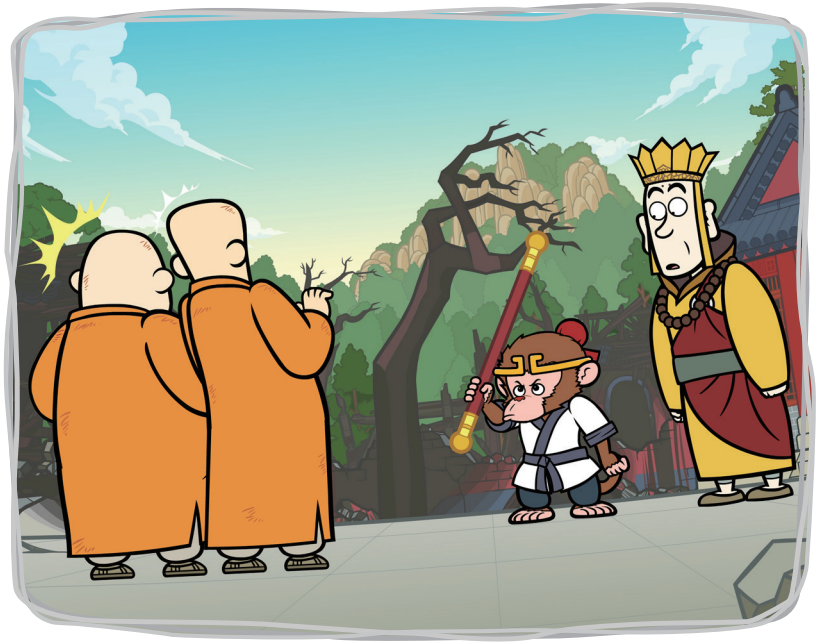
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Wukong glared at the two scared priests.

"The robe is gone?" he cried. "Where did it go?"

"We don't know!" said one priest.

"We tried to find it," added the other. "The robe was in a room that didn't get burned at all. But it's not there anymore."

His iron bar instantly appeared from inside his ear. "Grow!" commanded Wukong.



The monkey swung it toward the two priests.

But before the bar hit them, it dropped from the monkey's hands.

Wukong fell to the ground, crying in pain. "It hurts! It hurts!" he cried.

The Tang Monk was quietly reciting the Tight Headband spell. Wukong rolled around, kicking and screaming. The two priests jumped up and backed away.



“Stop reciting the spell!” Wukong yelled at the Tang Monk. “I’m begging you! I won’t hurt the priests!”

The Tang Monk stopped, and Wukong stood up. The monkey took a deep breath and put the iron bar back in his ear.

The Tang Monk looked at the two priests. “You really don’t know where the robe is?”

“No,” said one priest. “The head priest



ran away last night. He didn’t have it with him.”

Wukong tapped his chin. “A monster or demon might have stolen it. Are there any monsters or demons living near here?”

“Some people believe there’s a monster in the mountains nearby,” said the other priest. “They say it’s a black bear spirit.”

“I’ll go see if the bear took the robe,” said



Wukong. “I’ll be back soon.”

Wukong leaped into the air and landed up in the mountains. He walked for a bit and then heard voices. Peeking over a boulder, he saw a group of spirits talking. One was a large black bear.

The bear laughed. “The monastery was on fire last night. I went down to check it out and found a wonderful Buddhist robe. I think



it’s a Buddhist treasure. Anyway, I stole it. So tonight I’m throwing a feast to celebrate!”

When Wukong heard the other spirits laugh, he was furious. He jumped over the boulder and landed in the middle of the group.

“Give back the robe right now!” he cried. He pulled out his iron bar. “Or I’ll destroy all of you!”



The spirits all fled in different directions.

Wukong chased the bear until they reached a cave entrance. The bear ran inside and slammed the door shut.

Wukong pounded on the cave's door. "Come out here right now or I'll smash this door down!"

The door flew open. The bear stepped out. He was holding a lance.



"How dare you pound on my door and yell at me!" he cried.

"You stole my master's robe!" said Wukong.

"I can do whatever I want," said the bear. "I am the Black Wind King. I'm the most powerful monster in these mountains!"

"I am Sun Wukong, king of the Fruit and Flower Mountain," said the monkey. "I



caused lots of trouble in Heaven five hundred years ago. The Jade Emperor's entire army couldn't defeat me!"

The Black Wind King snorted. "You don't impress me." He jabbed his lance at Wukong. *Clang!* The monkey blocked the lance with his iron bar. Rocks tumbled and rolled downhill as the two warriors fought.

After an hour of fighting, the Black Wind



King held up a hand. "I need to take a break. It's time for my lunch."

Wukong's jaw fell open. "What?"

Before Wukong could say anything else, the bear ran back into his cave. The door slammed shut.